

MICHAEL ZARICK

STRATEGIC COMMUNICATIONS & PUBLIC RELATIONS



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Indianapolis, IN

PROFILE STATEMENT

I build narratives that connect communities to causes. Through Third Space Indy, I developed deep relationships with Indianapolis nonprofits, mutual aid organizations, and advocates working directly with unhoused neighbors, translating complex human experiences into compelling, accessible stories. CHIP believes the voices of those most impacted must be at the center of the work. That is the same conviction that drives every interview I produce. I am ready to bring that practice inside CHIP and help build the communications infrastructure to make that vision impossible to ignore.

PROFESSIONAL WORK EXPERIENCE

Founder, Producer & Host | Third Space Indy 2025 - Present

- Created and launched Third Space Indy, a civic journalism podcast with 50+ interviews spotlighting community builders, organizers, and advocates, including nonprofits and mutual aid groups serving Indianapolis's unhoused.
- Grew Instagram from 2,300 to 4,200 followers in 90 days (86% growth) through targeted outreach and cross-platform storytelling across YouTube, Apple Podcasts, Instagram, and TikTok.
- Secured paid sponsorships with Proformus and City Rising while building collaborative partnerships with organizations like Patina Art Gallery, translating mission-driven content into real community relationships.
- Co-produced a 13-mile citywide walk with We Walk Indy, drawing 50+ participants and building public awareness around walkability and transit as civic equity issues. I also got 25 new riders on the bus!

Project Manager | Orange Marketing 2025 - Present

- Oversees end-to-end communications and marketing implementation projects for a HubSpot Diamond Solutions Partner serving B2B, SaaS, and nonprofit clients.
- Builds and operationalizes communications infrastructure, including donor outreach workflows, content calendars, and CRM systems, helping organizations establish consistent, audience-centered messaging.
- Acts as the central point of communication between client stakeholders and technical resources, translating organizational goals into a clear, actionable strategy.
- Manages multiple concurrent client engagements, coordinating timelines, deliverables, and cross-functional teams

Founding Customer Success & Project Manager | Bottle.com 2021 - 2025

- Managed ongoing relationships across 150+ accounts, implementing HubSpot CRM to streamline lifecycle tracking, surface insights, and drive proactive engagement.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with product, marketing, and engineering teams to translate customer feedback into improvements, increasing engagement by 34% and improving retention by over 70%.
- Created systems for triage, knowledge base management, and support documentation, building the communications infrastructure for a fast-scaling startup.

Counselor in Training Director | YMCA Camp Piomingo 2013 - 2017

- Led leadership development curriculum for up to 30 teens per session, focused on communication, accountability, and conflict resolution in a fast-paced, unpredictable environment - you know... summer camp stuff.
- Managed daily program logistics and problem-solving across a large, cross-functional team of staff and campers.

Building Intern | Community Rebuilds 2018

- Helped construct two homes for low-income families in Moab, UT, as part of a community-based affordable housing initiative, an early formative experience with housing insecurity and the communities most impacted by it.

SKILLS AND TOOLS

- Communications & Strategy: Narrative development, brand voice, audience-centered messaging, media pitching
- Content & Production: Podcasting, longform interviews, social content, newsletters, video editing, copywriting
- Platforms & Tools: HubSpot, Canva, Notion, Slack, Google Workspace, Intercom, YouTube, Apple Podcasts
- Operations: Project management, workflow design, documentation, cross-functional coordination

EDUCATION

Computer Science

Indiana University Bloomington

Attended 2014 - 2019